

Special Topics in English (Advanced Speaking & Writing)

Subject (Classification)	English (Elective)	Credit(s)	3	Teacher(s)	Juhwan Kim Kevin Anderson	Classroom	2409-2
Course Title	Special Topics in English	Weekly Class Hours	3	Contact (Email/Phone/Office)			
				amstkim@gmail.com / anderson@ksa.hs.kr	051) 606-2217 / 2216	2309 / 2208	

1. Course Overview

Description				
As a special topics course, this course aims to offer EFL students a chance to read, analyze, discuss, and write about various types of texts written in English. Those texts include both literary and non-literary writings such as speeches, essays, newspaper/journal/magazine articles, short stories, and others. While many regard reading as a passive activity, this course aims to help students become <i>active</i> and <i>effective</i> readers. Active reading requires participating in the reading process: thinking about what you read, asking questions, and challenging ideas. Likewise, students will be engaged with a variety of spoken tasks such as oral interactions, including impromptu speaking, job interviews, research presentations, and public speaking. Working on the tasks, students will learn and practice idiomatic English associated with such communication, accurate pronunciation, stress, and intonation patterns in English, as well as critical listening skills for professional contexts.				
Objectives				
The following list includes specific objectives of the course: • To enhance English vocabulary and reading skills • To learn to identify key rhetorical concepts and terms, • To discuss how writers create meaning, • To relate personal experiences to the works we read, • To consider the larger social and cultural implications of the texts • To apply various critical perspectives to analyze the texts, • To write about the texts using various technologies and modes of composing, • To engage in written and verbal discussions about the texts, • To support analysis of and arguments about texts with scholarly sources, • To collaborate with peers on group-based, multimodal activities.				
CORE Competencies				
Creativity	Critical Thinking	Communication (in English)	Insights	Empathy

- ◆ **Creativity** is the interaction between the learning environment, both physical and social, the attitudes and attributes of both teachers and students, and a clear problem-solving process which produces a perceptible product (that can be an idea or a process as well as a tangible physical object).
- ◆ **Critical thinking** is the intellectually disciplined process of actively and skillfully conceptualizing, applying, analyzing, synthesizing, and/or evaluating information gathered from, or generated by, observation, experience, reflection, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to belief and action.
- ◆ **Communication** skill is the ability for an individual to accurately convey a message to another person or group of people. There are verbal and non-verbal communication skills. In this course, it also refers to the skill of communication using the English language.
- ◆ **Insights:** From a liberal arts perspective, insight refers to immediate and clear learning or understanding that takes place without overt trial-and-error testing. Insight occurs in human learning when people recognize relationships (or make novel associations between objects or actions) that can help them solve new problems.
- ◆ **Empathy**, an essential aspect of education and social-emotional learning competencies, is "the ability to recognize, appreciate, and understand another's state of mind or emotions, to be receptive to new ideas and perspectives, and to see, appreciate, and value differences and diversity in others." (Turner et al., "Standards for a course of study for teaching SEL skills K-8. 2019)

2. Textbook & References

- References: Muller, Gilbert H., and Harvey S. Wiener, eds. *The Short Prose Reader*; Henderson, Gloria M. et. al., eds. *Literature and Ourselves: A Thematic Introduction for Readers and Writers* (6th Edition). George, Diana, and John Trimbur, eds. *Reading Culture: Contexts for Critical Reading and Writing* (8th Edition). Knepler, Annie, et. al., *Crossing Cultures: Readings for Composition*. Houghton Mifflin (7th Edition).
- Supplements: Multimedia and Web Resources

3. Course Requirements & Assessment

Attendance	Participation	Journals (Writing)	Speeches (Presentation)	Mid-term Exam (Written Test)
15%	15%	20%	30 %	20 %

- Attendance: Attendance should be regular and faithful. Any absence without prior permission based on proper documentation will hurt one's grade substantially. Being late more than 10minutes will be considered as an absence. A tardy means being late more than 5 minutes. Two tardies will count as one absence.
- Class Participation: I expect students to read the assigned materials before they come to the class and be prepared to exchange their thoughts and ideas with others. Strong participation means they pay attention to what others say, ask and answer questions, make comments, and stay awake during class. Keep in mind that participation credit, which is to be evaluated in every class, is a key determinant of your final grade.
- Writing (Reading Journals): Students are required to write at least five reading journals, written responses in which they express their thoughts, feelings, and ideas based on their reading. Each

journal is expected to have an approximately 150-200-word length (1-2 FULL paragraphs). To get the full credit, it must be submitted before class on the due date. More details about the journal writing will be provided in class.

- Speeches (Oral Presentation): Students are also asked to prepare two oral presentations and deliver them in class: a 5-7 minute-long speech of personal narrative and a 12-15 minute-long academic presentation. Specific instructions will be given in time.
- Exams (Written Test): The exam will include multiple-choice questions, short-answer questions, and a short writing based on what students have learned in the class, either from the text and hand-outs or from my lectures.
- Final grades will be determined by the total points in the following scale: A+ (95~100), A0 (90~94), A- (88~89), B+ (85~87), B0 (80~84), B- (78~79), C+ (75~77), C0 (70~74), C- (68~69), D+ (65~67), D0 (60~64), D- (58~59), F (57 and below)
- Note: In case of an excused absence from the exam, the student's final grade will be assessed in compliance with the school's Academic Performance Management Regulations: the average score of performance assessments will be used as the basis score, or a separate written assessment may be administered. Article 10, Paragraph 3, states, "Regardless of whether a basis score can be calculated, if the course instructor deems it necessary, a separate written assessment for the absent student may be conducted with the consultation of the department council. (Amended Mar. 11, 2025)"

4. Weekly Schedule

* The following schedule is subject to change upon necessity. Any change will be announced ahead of class. Each class will include a variety of activities such as vocab work, short lecture, in-class reading/writing, multimedia screening, Q&A, and discussion. Handouts and supplementary materials will be used as needed.

Week 1: Course Overview / Introduction

Week 2-4: Classic Short Stories (5-6 stories to be selected)

- Edgar Allan Poe - "The Tell-Tale Heart" (1843)
 - James Joyce - "Araby" (1914)
 - William Faulkner - "A Rose for Emily" (1930)
 - John Steinbeck - "The Chrysanthemums" (1937)
 - Richard Wright - "The Man Who Was Almost a Man" (1940)
 - Shirley Jackson - "The Lottery" (1948)
 - Ray Bradbury - "The Veldt" (1950)
 - Kurt Vonnegut - "Harrison Bergeron" (1961)
 - Alice Walker - "Everyday Use" (1971)
 - Ursula K. LeGuin - "The Ones Who Walk Away from Omelas" (1973)
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Weeks 5-6: Non-Fiction Essays (4-5 essays to be selected)

- George Orwell - "Shooting an Elephant" (1936)
- John Steinbeck - "Starvation Under the Orange Trees" (1936)
- Joan Didion - "Goodbye to All That" (1967)
- Rachel L. Jones - "What's Wrong with Black English?" (1983)
- Leonard Pitts - "We'll Go Forward" (2001)

- Malcolm Gladwell - "The Ketchup Conundrum" (2004)
 - Mark Slouka - "Quitting the Paint Factory" (2004)
 - Mandy Len Catron - "To Fall in Love With Anyone" (2015)
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Weeks 7–8: Famous Speeches (4-5 speeches to be selected)

- Abraham Lincoln - "Gettysburg Address" (1863)
 - Martin Luther King Jr. - "I Have a Dream" (1963)
 - Gloria Steinem Vassar Speech (1970)
 - Harvey Milk's Final Speech (1978)
 - Steve Jobs Stanford Commencement (2005)
 - Greta Thunberg UN Speech (2019)
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Week 9: Mid-term Exam (No Class)

Week 10: Speeches by Students (1st. Oral Presentation)

Weeks 11–13: Advanced Short Stories (4-5 stories to be selected)

- Nathaniel Hawthorne - "Young Goodman Brown" (1835)
 - Stephen Crane - "The Open Boat" (1897)
 - Jack London - "To Build a Fire" (1908)
 - Gabriel García Márquez - "A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings" (1955)
 - Joyce Carol Oates - "Where Are You Going, Where Have You Been?" (1966)
 - Ted Chiang - "Exhalation" (2008)
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Weeks 14–15: Newspaper, Magazine, Journal Articles (4-5 articles to be selected)

- The Guardian – Long Reads
 - National Geographic Features - Scientific Journalism
 - Science News for Students
 - Pulitzer Prize-Winning Journalism
 - The New Yorker - Literary Journalism
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Week 16: Speeches by Students (2nd Oral Presentation)

Week 17: Final Exam (No Class, End of Semester)



Pledge of Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is a commitment to honest and moral behavior in an academic setting. All members of KSA, an academic institution and community, share the same commitment and therefore must be responsible for any violation of the honor code that is to be regulated by the school.

Violation of the Academic Honor Code includes:

- Giving your work (homework, exams, answer key for homework and/or exams, feedback regarding exams, etc.) to other students
- Accepting or copying homework from another student who gave you the answers
- Paying someone else to write your paper or do your homework
- Cheat sheet used for closed-book exams
- Stealing the test
- Collaborating on work that the teacher expects to be done independently
- Plagiarism

Year/Semester: 2025-2 (Fall)

Course Title: Special Topics in English (Advanced Speaking & Writing)

Teacher: Juhwan Kim

All assignments in this class are expected to be students' own, completed by themselves specifically for this class. If students receive tutoring or any other help, in person or online, they must indicate that on the assignment, including any relevant links or contact information of the assistants. For everything in this class, all sources must be cited. Sharing course materials with anyone outside the class is prohibited. All use of commercial homework assistance for anything related to this course is prohibited, and considered an honor code violation.

I affirm and pledge that I will not plagiarize, use unauthorized materials, or give or receive illegitimate help on assignments, papers or examinations. I will uphold fairness and honesty in my work and the work of others.

Student Printed Name:

Signature:

Date: